LEARNER ATTACHMENT

PHI Redaction Procedure and Verification Checklist

Incident-record minimization procedure - Version 1.0

IMPORTANT DISTINCTION This procedure minimizes identifiers in a training incident record. It does not, by itself, establish HIPAA de-identification under the Safe Harbor or Expert Determination methods.

Required substitutions

Data type	Training replacement	Verification
Patient name	Patient A, Patient B, or consistent sequential role label	Search visible text, OCR text, filenames, and metadata
Medical record number	[MRN REMOVED]	Search digit strings and labels such as MRN / chart number
Date of birth	[DOB REMOVED]	Search date formats and document properties
Provider/workforce name	Attending Physician or approved role label	Program confidentiality control; not automatically PHI solely because it identifies a provider
Username / email	Affected Workforce Account	Check headers, screenshots, links, and attachment names
PHI-bearing filename or URL path	Artifact A-01 or approved evidence ID	Check display text and hyperlink target

Procedure

1. Work from an approved copy; preserve the original evidence unchanged in the restricted evidence repository.
2. Inventory every visible and hidden identifier: document text, screenshots, filenames, headers, comments, metadata, alt text, hyperlinks, and embedded objects.
3. Apply the approved substitution consistently across every artifact and transfer summary.
4. For images, use an irreversible redaction method; a movable shape or translucent box is not sufficient.
5. Export the final artifact, reopen it, and search/inspect again. Record Clean or Needs another pass for each artifact.

Per-artifact verification checklist

- Patient names and unique identifiers removed or replaced.
- MRNs and DOBs removed.
- Workforce identifiers replaced under program policy.
- Filenames, URLs, metadata, comments, tracked changes, alt text, and hidden text checked.

- Subject lines, chat headers, and attachment names checked.
- Final exported file reopened and visually inspected.
- Outcome and reviewer timestamp recorded.

Authoritative sources

- HHS - Summary of the HIPAA Privacy Rule
- HHS - Minimum Necessary Requirement
- HHS - Guidance Regarding Methods for De-identification of PHI
- HHS - Summary of the HIPAA Security Rule